

scored high on job security. Even during Covid, the bank maintained its compensation, bonus, and promotion cycles at pre-Covid levels. “Whatever actions we typically take in a normal year, we maintained in 2020,” says Razdan. This consistency instilled confidence and a sense of security.

In FY24, the bank surprised its employees with an ex-gratia payment worth ₹1,500 crore. “It is our way of trying to say thank you to the ground workforce,” said Jagdishan in an investor call this April.

THE LEARNING CURVE

In July 2023, the bank introduced MPower, a new learning management system, and Learning Experience Platform, hosting rich content, in partnership with global players like EdCast by Cornerstone, Upside, Harvard, Udemy, and Skillsoft. This provides access to content across areas like leadership, strategy, technology, banking and finance, etc. “This engaging content in a variety of formats provides insights and contemporary practices that help our talent perform well and thrive in a rapidly-evolving business landscape,” says Razdan.

Through EdCast, the bank provides a learning experience customised to individual preferences. For example, if a relationship manager is travelling between calls and has 20 minutes to spare, he can log into the platform and watch a learning video clip tailored to his interests.

Another aspect of learning comes from the rotation of portfolios. People are undertaking new roles, stepping out of their comfort zones, accepting new assignments, all while having the safety net of solid organisational systems. “It gives them a holistic experience,” Razdan adds. Three months after the merg-



Key HR initiatives

- ▶ **MD & CEO's bus tours to get first-hand feedback**
- ▶ **Introduced MPower, a new learning management system, and Learning Experience Platform**
- ▶ **Partnership with EdCast, Upside, Harvard, Udemy, and Skillsoft for learning initiatives**
- ▶ **Relying on gamification to simulate real-life conditions for learning. Recently, the bank rolled out Strategy Lab @ HDFC Bank for senior executives**

er became effective in July 2023, the bank restructured its top deck.

The bank offers appropriate training programmes, including formal classroom interventions and is also relying on gamification to simulate real-life conditions for learning. Recently, the bank rolled out Strategy Lab @ HDFC Bank for its senior executives, curated in partnership with BTS, a global strategy execution consulting firm.

The programme is contextualised through a real-life banking simulation with elements of strategic decision-making.

“A large part of our effort goes

into strengthening and enriching the experience that each leader provides to their team members. We have a comprehensive strategy for this—nurture, care, collaborate,” Razdan adds.

Within that framework, the bank conducts performance appraisal, development, and care-related conversations to ensure that every person is supported and guided appropriately.

“Over the last 20 years, we have seen stalwarts who have come and gone, but the organisation has continued to roll and move forward with a lot of energy and even more gusto,” said Jagdishan in the investors’ call.

Jagdishan said the company is process-driven and process-dependent.

“It’s an auto engine that will chug along in any kind of an environment,” he added.

With that in mind, HDFC Bank has clearly created an institutional platform with management depth that goes beyond the top brass. **BT**

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